

A SATIRICAL SOCIAL THRILLER

RICH

Everybody's got a price. His was eternal.

FEATURE FILM · STORY TREATMENT

After selling his soul to a secret cabal for money and fame, a rising social-media star discovers a conspiracy to influence the masses through entertainment. Now he wants out — but the price may be more than he can afford.



HOW MUCH DOES A DOLLAR REALLY COST?

A broke twenty-something with a rising feed sells his soul to an ancient order for everything he ever wanted. When he learns what the machine really feeds on and tries to walk away, he's given **seventy-two hours** to reach the mansion where his contract is sealed in blood — and burn it — while everything the order controls hunts him down.

STORY TREATMENT

THE LOGLINE

— THE STORY

THE DESCENT

One man trades everything he has — then watches it take everything he loves.

I

THE DEAL

To save his dying mother, Rich takes an oath to an ancient brotherhood. One bloodied handprint. A million-dollar check. Everything he ever wanted.

II

THE RISE & THE FALL

Fame. Money. A mansion. Rich becomes a living product — told what to wear, what to say, what to sell — until the lifestyle he's selling kills his little brother.

III

THE RECKONING

Grieving and finally awake, Rich sees what he's been feeding the world. He wants out. The order has other plans.

Then they offer him a way out — and start a clock.

I

ACT ONE

The Deal

Rich is twenty-something and broke — a young man with an ironic name and nothing in the bank to justify it. He works two dead-end jobs, the steadiest a graveyard shift behind the counter of a corner store, to keep a roof over a small apartment and his mother, Hannah, in a treatment facility she can no longer afford. Hannah is dying of stage-three pancreatic cancer. His younger brother, Sam, still impressionable, watches Rich the way a boy watches the man of the house — because, with their father gone, that is what Rich has become.

The one thing that's rising is his feed. Rich has a way with people, a charisma that reads through a phone screen, and a social channel climbing faster than his bank balance ever will. It earns him attention. It doesn't earn him rent.

Then a man walks into the store. **Rob** — expensive, unhurried, Tom Ford glasses and a watch worth more than the building — tells Rich he's been watching, that he sees something in him, and hands him an invitation to a party at his estate.

The next day, everything collapses at once. A belligerent customer turns an ordinary shift into an altercation; Rich is fired, arrested, and slapped with a lawsuit. He's bailed out by an anonymous benefactor — and learns the suit has evaporated, because the customer has turned up dead of an apparent overdose. He comes home to a dark apartment, the power cut, and the news that Hannah has been turned out of her facility over an unpaid balance and no insurance.

Out of options, out of pride, Rich calls Rob.

The address leads to a sprawling estate on the edge of the city — an opulent mansion ringed by manicured grounds and, strangely, a private menagerie of caged animals. Inside, the party is wall-to-wall with A-listers and people of real influence. Every guest is dressed in a costume provided at the door; the famous wear one design, the newcomers another — rank made visible at a glance.

The new faces are led through a sequence of rooms, each staged as one of the seven deadly sins — sloth; envy and pride; gluttony and greed; lust; and, finally, wrath. When the rituals are done, the initiates are brought into a great library and offered an oath: swear yourself to the order, and be promised wealth and prosperity without end. Each one who agrees presses a bloodied handprint into a book; the book is shelved among hundreds like it. In return — a check for one million dollars.

Reluctant, grieving, desperate, Rich takes the oath. His handprint dries on the page. The book goes back on the shelf.

II

ACT TWO

The Rise & The Fall

Time passes, and the promise keeps itself. Rich is wealthy. He's known. The big house, the cars, the women, a family finally taken care of — everything he ever pictured, delivered. Rob returns to tell him he's due for a promotion, and that the two of them will be working closely now. He explains the order properly for the first time: men of power, chosen centuries ago by ancient spirits, granted wealth and influence to remake the world toward its "original glory." He gives Rich a book on the occult and the esoteric and waves it off with a smile — old wives' tales.

But the promotion has a price written in fine print. Rob begins steering Rich's content: videos that reinforce ugly stereotypes, endorse destructive habits, manufacture trends. The more Rich feeds the machine, the more his own life corrodes. He loses himself inside the brand until he's less a person than a living product endorsement — told what to wear, what to say, how to act, what to sell.

He falls in with **Delilah**, a lifestyle influencer whose whole gospel is excess, and she turns his slow burn of fame into a vicious cycle: drugs, sex, spectacle — debauchery dressed up as the good life.

And then the life takes its first real thing. At a party in Rich's own home, his brother Sam — older now, but still trying to be like him — drinks a medicated beverage that's gone viral in part because of Rich's own videos. He has a bad reaction. He overdoses. He dies. The drink is legal, the drug is legal, and so Rich is charged with nothing — which is its own kind of sentence. He would have taken prison gladly over burying his brother.

Sam's death is the wake-up. For the first time, Rich sees clearly what he's been pushing into the world — and what it does to the young who trust a face on a screen.

He ends it with Delilah. He renounces the drugs. He sits with his grieving mother and tells her he's walking away from all of it.

III

ACT THREE

Seventy-Two Hours

He tells Rob he wants out. Rob tells him the terms. There is a way to be released, exactly one: return to the library where his handprint was sealed, find the book, and burn it. He has seventy-two hours. In that window the order will use every resource it commands to stop him — short of killing him. If he's caught, he belongs to them forever. Rob hands him a gun and an address: the mansion outside the city.

Then the world tilts. Broken things in Rich's home are mysteriously repaired; objects appear in places he never left them. He keeps seeing the same faces around him — out in the city, near his door — and then they're gone, and he can't be sure they were ever there. People he's just spoken with have no memory of the conversation, or of him. His grip on what's real begins to slip, and paranoia moves in.

He goes back to the occult book Rob gave him, and the pieces lock together into something monstrous: the spirits behind the order have an end far more insidious than "a better world." The media — the lifestyles, the opinions, the drugs sold as cures — is an instrument of control, conditioning the masses to be quietly taken over. Rich decides Sam will not have died for nothing. He's going to set people free.

He takes it to one of the biggest podcasts in the world and says it all out loud — that the public is being manipulated and farmed toward someone else's ends. The feed is cut. He's chased from the building by the staff, every face in the room suddenly an enemy. What none of them know: the whole thing was being secretly livestreamed, right up to the moment of the attack.

It goes viral instantly — millions of views, millions of reactions. Rich rushes to the hospital to see his mother, and watches a doctor slip something into her line. She seizes. She dies in front of him. He's thrown out with a warning. *He should have stayed quiet.*

— THE HUNT · IT ISN'T ASSASSINS. IT'S EVERYONE.

The public can't look away. Rich leans all the way in, telling the world the full story of his attempt to escape the "illuminati," then makes the call that keeps him alive: he livestreams everything. If he's always visible, taking him out becomes too costly. Strangers begin to help — feeding him directions, opening doors, offering places to hide along the route.

The order can't kill him quietly now, so it goes to work on his name. Influencers and celebrities line up to call him toxic and dangerous. Stories of abuse surface. Several women accuse him of drugging and assaulting them. Doctors and psychologists produce falsified records of a disturbed childhood and brand him a violent psychopath. The smear turns much of the public against him — but he keeps moving.

So the order escalates. Hitmen murder some of the people who helped him on camera, and the killings are pinned on Rich. Now he's a fugitive wanted for murder, dead or alive, SWAT on his trail and the crowd that once guided him turned hostile. He goes dark.

Closer to the mansion, he finds refuge in a small church and its pastor. He tells the man everything. The pastor cuts his hair and changes his clothes to help him disappear — and tells him the one truth the order never accounts for: the covenant Rich signed can be broken by a **superior covenant**, the blood of Christ, which overrides any oath and grants him both the right to break free and protection from the darkness hunting him.

He prays with Rich. Then SWAT breaches the doors. The pastor presses his car keys into Rich's hand and is shot dead by police as the church burns behind them.

On the third day, Rich reaches the mansion — and instead of an ambush, he's welcomed. They greet him with delight, congratulate him on surviving the journey, and bury him in luxury and comfort. They also gaslight him, rewriting events to make him doubt his own memory, working to break him from the inside. They throw a banquet in his honor and lay down an impossible choice.

Leave, and they'll call off everything — the armed forces, the smear, all of it — but he'll be utterly on his own. Or stay, and be restored higher than he ever was. To tip the scale, they bring out his mother and his brother, alive, and promise to reunite his family if he remains. Unseen by Rich, the spirits show their true faces in private, wearing human ones in the room.

For twenty-four hours he's tempted with everything — the same five rituals from the night he was initiated, run in reverse to gratify every appetite of heart and flesh until he folds. They even offer him the doctor who killed his mother, served up as justice, if he'll only take it.

At the stroke of twelve, Rob and the masters of the order gather for his answer.

He refuses.

So they attack. Rich fights his way through the house, triggers an explosion in the kitchen, and sets the mansion ablaze. Rob cuts him off in the library — the room where it all began — and beats him savagely, finally revealing what he is: a spirit assigned to Rich's life and bloodline, tasked with steering his destiny from birth.

Rob raises the gun to finish it. Before he can fire, the room floods with pure light. An angel steps out of it and stands over Rich.

Rob recoils in terror and runs — straight into one of the estate's caged lions, loosed in the chaos, which tears him apart. The lion fixes its eyes on Rich for a long moment, then bolts into the dark.

Rich drags himself out as the mansion burns to the ground, his book inside it.

The deal is ash. He's free.

— EPILOGUE

THE NEW WEARS OFF

Time passes. Rich looks different now, and answers to a different name, working the floor of an electronics store in a town no one knows him in. On his break he scrolls, and there's one of his old collaborators on a major platform — dancing in a dress, telling his followers how a weight-loss drug built his dream body. Nothing has changed. The machine kept running without him.

A customer recognizes him from the livestreams. He says he's a believer in Rich's story, that he works for a media company trying to bring truth to the world, that there's a huge audience waiting to hear him. He slides a luxurious card across the counter and invites him to a little get-together.

Rich looks it over. He hands it back. *He's good right where he is.*



THE LIGHTS COME DOWN. THE CROWD GOES HOME.

— THE ANTAGONIST

THE ORDER

They treat their own existence as a joke.

Known to the initiated only as the Order, the Fraternity, the Brotherhood — and dismissed as a conspiracy theorist's fever dream by everyone else. It has no formal name, no paper trail, no proof, and its members treat the very idea of it as a joke in public. It is invisible. But its fingerprint is on everything, if you have eyes to see.

It was founded by kings, rulers, and the most accomplished men of their ages, who gathered in strongholds across the world and communed with ancient spirits. The spirits offered "illumination" — and a bargain: the power to bend the world to their will, and prosperity in everything they touched, in exchange for working as one to build a "better world" in the image of the ancients. That commission has been handed down for millennia, running through every industry that shapes a life — food, medicine, media, politics, fashion, banking. Not merely present in them. Steering them.

THE METHOD

Through the media they program the population: degrade the family so the young are easier to mold; bury subliminal messaging in music; normalize and glorify the destructive; stoke division between genders and political tribes; sell new drugs as miracle cures for the aches of modern life.



THEIR INSTRUMENT IS ENTERTAINMENT.
THEIR PRODUCT IS YOU.

THE AGENDA

Fracture the family.

Normalize the destructive.

Sell the cure.

Keep the people divided, desperate, and easy to mold.

— THE PLAYERS

RICH

THE PROTAGONIST

A down-on-his-luck twenty-something with big dreams and a small life, saddled with an ironic name. He lives with his brother Sam and his dying mother Hannah in a cramped apartment, bills piling up, working a dead-end store job that barely covers rent and her care — always one missed payment from losing both. He's impulsive and stubborn, but he has a genuine gift with people, the one thing that might carry him out. His channel is climbing; it just isn't paying yet. When Rob offers a way to change everything, desperation and the allure of wealth win. He gets it all — and loses his identity, his brother, and very nearly his soul. The reward for escape is freedom; the cost is higher than he can imagine.

ROB

THE HANDLER

The agent who opens the door. Bespoke suits, a watch worth a house, an estate worth a city block — and no past: no background, no aliases, no record of how he rose. He commands everyone who matters in media and hosts vast, disturbing parties at his estate. Charming in a way that never quite sits right. Behind the Tom Ford glasses is something not of this world — in truth, a spirit, assigned to Rich's bloodline to control its destiny.

DELILAH

THE TEMPTATION

A firecracker of an influencer whose entire brand is the "get a bag, blow the bag" life — travel, parties, fashion, indulgence, and a healthy appetite for "party favors." She's the one who turns Rich's slow drain of fame into a vicious cycle, pulling him into a world of drugs, sex, and opulence, and accelerating his undoing.

SAM

THE COST

Rich's younger, impressionable brother and his closest bond. With their father gone, Sam sees Rich as the man of the house and wants to be just like him. When Rich makes it big, Sam dives in alongside him — and it's the first thing the life takes. He overdoses on a medicated drink made viral, in part, by his own brother's videos. Because the drug is legal, no one is charged. Rich would have taken the prison sentence gladly.

HANNAH

THE ANCHOR

Rich and Sam's mother, dying of stage-three pancreatic cancer, her care sinking the family deeper with every passing month. A woman of devout faith, she keeps their small apartment a happy home against every odd — certain the Lord will sustain them, and that her boys will reach their dreams even if she isn't there to see it. The line she drills into her sons is the thread Rich follows home.

P S A L M 23 : 4

*"Yea, though I walk through the valley of the
shadow of death,
I will fear no evil; for You are with me;
Your rod and Your staff, they comfort me."*

What's It All Really Worth?

How much does a dollar really cost?

The story interrogates what fame and success cost when the price is your soul. Life after life — Rich's chief among them — comes apart, and some are lost outright, in the pursuit and the love of unmoderated excess. The dollar, it turns out, is never just a dollar.

Who Even Are You?

Are your desires your own — or were you built to want them?

What wakes Rich is the realization that people are shaped by what they consume — and that he's been a puppet helping to shape them. The film holds a microscope to what we've been conditioned to accept: the stereotypes, the recreational drugs sold as cures for our lives' ailments, the dissolution of family, the gender wars and political divides, the crises of identity — nearly all of it introduced or amplified by media. In a world raised on its phones, where misinformation runs at an all-time high, the question has never mattered more.

It Is All Vanity & Vexation of Spirit

He got everything, and lost the only things that ever mattered.

By the end, Rich accepts where he's been left, and when another open door appears, he turns it down. His hunger for more cost him the only things that mattered — and now that he's had it all, he wants his old life back. The new wears off. The lights come down. The crowd goes home. All that's left is what's in your heart — and when you've bought the world at the expense of your soul, even that becomes vanity, and vexation of spirit.

— THE LOOK

*A24 social thriller meets
Fincher paranoia. Gloss on top.
Rot underneath.*

Antique gold against near-black. Ritual symmetry in the mansion; handheld vertigo on the run. The order's world is composed, controlled, expensive — every frame an advertisement. Rich's unraveling is the opposite: phones, feeds, and notifications bleeding into reality until you can't tell the set from the world.

ELEVATED HORROR · FINCHER COLD · FASHION EDITORIAL · SMARTPHONE DYSTOPIA
· BIBLICAL RITUAL

— IN CONVERSATION WITH

Eyes Wide Shut 1999

A secret cabal manipulating an unsuspecting man's mind and life, shrouded in mystery, performing rituals of sex and drugs as he loses his grip on reality. Its masked, costumed ceremony and mood of luxurious dread directly seed RICH's tone and the five-room initiation. Its ending — the protagonist quietly surveilled, the people closest to him already inside the group — mirrors the order's inescapability.

The Truman Show 1998

A man's entire life staged and broadcast for a hidden audience without his knowledge; when he sees it, reality opens for the first time. RICH borrows its core — lives engineered to run in cycles by those in control, and the terror and liberation of finally seeing the set for what it is.

John Wick: Chapter 2 2017

One man against the world, a bounty turning every stranger into a threat, obstacle after obstacle between him and the next step. RICH takes the same engine and widens it: it isn't only assassins hunting him — it's the media, the influencers, the courts, the hospitals. Everything that can be turned against him, is.

Memento 2000

A reality rendered deliberately ambiguous, a protagonist unsure whether what he's living is real. As the order's manipulations escalate, Rich unravels the same way — questioning his own mind, never certain how much is happening to him and how much he's imagining.

THE SPARK: THE INTERNET'S OWN OBSESSION — VIRAL "ILLUMINATI" CONFESSIONS AND THE GENRE OF VIDEOS DECODING HIDDEN MESSAGES IN PLAIN SIGHT — ASKED OUT LOUD.

— WHY NOW

*We have never lived more
of our lives inside the feed
— or trusted less of what
we find there.*

5.4B+

PEOPLE ON SOCIAL MEDIA — ROUGHLY TWO-
THIRDS OF HUMANITY

3h 38m

A DAY FOR 16-24-YEAR-OLDS — THE
HEAVIEST USERS

\$250B → \$480B

CREATOR ECONOMY · 2024 — PROJECTED
2027 (GOLDMAN SACHS)

A generation is being raised by recommendation
engines, in the highest-misinformation
environment in history. RICH turns that anxiety
into a thriller — and asks what everyone is quietly
circling: *who is writing your life?*



RAISED BY THE ALGORITHM.

— THE MARKET

SMALL BUDGET, CULTURAL EVENT

Elevated genre is where small budgets become cultural events.

GET OUT

\$4.5M → \$255M

WORLDWIDE · BEST ORIGINAL
SCREENPLAY

NIGHTCRAWLER

\$8.5M → \$50M

NEO-NOIR MEDIA SATIRE

UNCUT GEMS

\$19M → \$50M

A24 · ANXIETY AS CINEMA

In conversation with Get Out, Saltburn, Sorry to Bother You, and Squid Game — satire of wealth and spectacle, built for global reach.

THE AUDIENCE

Built for the very online — Gen Z and Millennials, fans of elevated horror and prestige satire. A faith-and-redemption spine broadens the room well beyond genre.

THE TRANSMEDIA PLAY

The film's own engine is a livestream that goes viral. RICH is a movie about virality, built to be viral — a social-first rollout, an ARG around "the book," and a hero who livestreams his own escape.



RICH

Everybody's got a price. His was eternal.

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